

Rezūm (Water Vapor Therapy)

Patient Information · An office treatment for an enlarged prostate

WARWIKI

Rezūm treats an enlarged prostate (BPH) that slows your urine stream. Small puffs of **steam** are placed into the prostate through a thin scope. The treated tissue shrinks over the next few months and opens the channel. It is often done **in the office**, and most men **keep their erections and ejaculation**.

About This Treatment

The prostate surrounds the urethra just below the bladder. When it grows, it can squeeze the channel. During Rezūm, a thin scope is passed through the urethra and a small needle releases **water vapor** into the prostate for about 9 seconds at a time. The heat kills the extra tissue, and your body clears it away over weeks. Nothing is cut out, and there is no cut on the skin.

Benefits and Risks in Numbers

About half

less trouble from urinary symptoms, lasting 5 years in the main study

4 in 100

needed another prostate operation within 5 years

3 in 100

stopped ejaculating. No lasting new erection problems in the main study

Numbers are averages from published studies. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

Is It Right for Me?

- The best evidence is for **small to medium prostates**. It can also treat a middle lobe.
- It is a good fit if you want to **avoid an operating room** and keep your ejaculation.
- **It works slowly**. Symptoms can be worse for the first few weeks, and the full effect takes about 3 months.
- It may not be suitable if you have an artificial urinary sphincter or a penile implant.
- Urine flow improves less than after surgery such as TURP or HoLEP.

Learn the Terms

BPH

An enlarged prostate that is not cancer.

Water vapor (steam)

Heated water that kills extra prostate tissue.

Urethra

The tube that carries urine out of the body. It runs through the prostate.

Middle lobe

A part of the prostate that can bulge into the bladder and block flow.

Catheter

A soft tube that drains the bladder for a few days while swelling settles.

TURP and HoLEP

Operations that remove prostate tissue in an operating room.

Will it hurt? You get numbing medicine, and often medicine by mouth to help you relax; some men have sedation. Most feel pressure and brief heat or cramping during each puff. The treatment itself takes about 5 to 10 minutes.

Same day

Home the same day, usually with a catheter.

First days

The catheter comes out after a few days; some men need it longer.

First few weeks

Burning, urgency and some blood in the urine. This settles.

About 3 months

Full benefit. Your team checks your symptoms and flow.

How to Get Ready

- A **urine test** checks for infection first. Any infection is treated before Rezūm.
- Your prostate may be measured with a scan or a scope.
- Tell your team about **blood thinners**. They will tell you whether to stop them; do not stop them on your own.
- Arrange a ride home if you will have sedation.

What Happens

- 1 Numbing gel goes into the urethra. Some men also get a numbing injection near the prostate.
- 2 A thin scope is passed into the urethra.
- 3 Steam is placed at several spots along each side of the prostate.
- 4 A catheter is usually placed to drain urine while swelling settles.

After Rezūm

- Drink fluids. Avoid constipation and straining.
- Burning, urgency, going often and blood in the urine are common for a few weeks. You may also see blood in your semen.
- Keep taking your prostate medicine until your team tells you to stop.

Call the office that did your treatment if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Burning or pain that gets worse instead of better
- A weak stream or a feeling that you are not emptying after the catheter is out

Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot urinate for several hours and your bladder feels full or painful
- Your urine looks like red wine or has clots, or the catheter stops draining
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. Rezūm uses steam to shrink prostate tissue, often in the office.
2. It works slowly: expect a catheter for a few days and full benefit by about 3 months.
3. Most men keep their erections and ejaculation.